

BRAND VOICE WORKSHOP

Lamar Dodd School of Art

Building a brand voice that guides AI-generated social content.

An internal workshop recap.

What this is — and isn't

- A **working voice reference** that steers how PolyWiz writes the School's social posts.
- **Not** an official UGA / Franklin / Dodd brand guideline, and not for wider distribution.
- It **complements** — never replaces — the School's own brand work.
- Built from the School's own public voice, so it lands close to a full brand-voice workshop. The scope is just narrower: **content generation**.

What is PolyWiz?

- The tool used to **generate and schedule** the School's social content across platforms.
- It drafts posts from a URL — an exhibition, a story, an artist page.
- The voice guide tells the AI **how Lamar Dodd should sound**, so posts feel **authored**, not generic.

What we did

- Researched three voices: **UGA, Franklin College**, and **Lamar Dodd's own** website.
- Distilled UGA + Franklin into short **tone summaries**.
- Explored **Dodd's identity in depth**.
- Composed one consolidated **voice & content guide**, modeled on a proven arts-org pattern.

Why we did it

- **Consistent, on-brand posts at scale** — without hand-writing each one.
- **Anti-generic:** make AI copy sound like Dodd, not like every other art school.
- A **single source of truth** the whole team — and the tool — can point to.

The approach — layered inheritance

- Dodd sits inside a hierarchy: **UGA** → **Franklin College** → **Lamar Dodd**.
- Summarize each parent for **tone only**; let Dodd's **own** voice lead.
- Template the guide on the **NOT REAL ART** pattern — a voice guide built for arts orgs.
- Research: **Perplexity** (UGA pages) · the **Franklin PDF** · **Firecrawl** (art.uga.edu).

[Read the full method →](#)

UGA — brand voice (summary)

- **"We write like we talk."** Earnest, personal, human — the warm end of the register.
- **Positioning:** inspire those who lead, discover and serve — "a relentless pursuit to improve the world."
- **For an arts sub-brand:** keep the warmth and "show, don't say"; dial down rankings and the "since 1785" gravity.

[Full UGA summary →](#) · [Full UGA research →](#)

Franklin College — voice (summary)

- **The big idea:** the convergence of arts and sciences — the "Franklin Spark."
- **Four voice modes:** Inclusively Sophisticated · Ambitiously Inquisitive · Pragmatically Inspired · Powerfully Purposeful.
- **House style:** bold, declarative, strong active verbs; anti-gatekeeping; human but not too casual.

[Full Franklin summary →](#)

Lamar Dodd — explored in depth

- Flagship art school; top-ranked in the Southeast for ~100 years; comprehensive (16+ programs).
- **What makes it Dodd:** Athens' creative scene (R.E.M., Pylon), Cortona, the Athenaeum, a craft-art legacy, a fully-funded MFA, and an unusually honest history.
- **Its own stance:** "an advocate for the belief that art and design are important for the quality of life."
- **Anchor:** Creative Research. Academic Excellence. Community. Collaboration.

[Full Dodd research digest →](#)

How it drives generation — two layers that work together

Layer 1 — the Voice Guide (this document)

The qualitative **how we sound**: story focus, do's & don'ts, real examples. One text field the model reads on **every** post.

Layer 2 — the Tone-of-Voice sliders

The quantitative dials: **8 tone dimensions** + an overall **intensity** (Professional → Full Voice), tuned per campaign.

Both feed the **same prompt** — the guide gives the **character**, the sliders set how **loud** it speaks.

The result — already live

- Composed, reviewed, and **entered into the brand configuration**.
- Two copies live in the repo for you to read and edit:
 - **Markdown** (nicely formatted): [open on GitHub →](#)
 - **Plain text** (edit + send back): [open on GitHub →](#)
- To suggest changes: edit the **.txt**, send it back by email or file. We reconcile it and update the config by hand.

Everything we made — click to open on GitHub

- **Method:** [METHOD.md](#)
- **UGA:** [summary](#) · [full research](#)
- **Franklin:** [summary](#)
- **Lamar Dodd:** [research digest](#) · [voice guide — Markdown](#) · [voice guide — plain text](#)

THANK YOU

Questions or edits?

Send a marked-up **.txt** to Juergen — we'll take it from there.